Draft - expert review pending

This unit is complete and passes the platform’s automated checks, but no reviewer has read it yet. Treat its sources and claims with care.

Unit 2 teacher notes

Sequencing note

The three topics follow the logic of a single reading event. Topic 2.1 asks what the writer brought to the text; Topic 2.2 asks what strategies the reader brings; Topic 2.3 asks trainees to combine both in practice. Teach them in order across the four weeks the content-spec allows.

Common misconceptions to probe

1. **"Reading means decoding every word."** This is the most persistent one. Probe it by asking: "If you can read every word but cannot answer questions about the text, have you read it?" Trainees who equate reading with decoding will find the strategy sections counter-intuitive.

2. **"Listening is a passive skill."** Probe it by asking: "If someone speaks to you in Urdu while you are thinking about something else, have you listened?" The goal is to make the case that listening requires active engagement.

3. **"Critical reading means finding faults."** Probe it by asking: "Can a text be well-written and still be biased?" The goal is to shift from fault-finding to understanding how a text works.

Managing the activities

Topic 2.1 - Analyse two texts on the same topic (25 minutes, pairs). The trap is that trainees identify purpose without explaining how they know. Push them back: "What evidence in the text tells you the purpose is X and not Y?"

Topic 2.2 - Apply SQ4R to a text (30 minutes, individual). The trap is that trainees skip the "question" step and go straight to reading. Remind them: "The question is what makes you read with a purpose. Without it, you are just reading words."

Topic 2.3 - Analyse a complete text (30 minutes, groups of three). This is the most cognitively demanding activity. The trap is that trainees list features without evaluating them. Push them back: "You have identified the bias. Now tell me: does it matter? Does it affect the reliability of the text?"

Practical work and practicum links

Each topic carries a "Try this at your practicum school" task. The unit works best when the tutor sets these up explicitly before trainees leave for practicum and debriefs them when trainees return.

- **Topic 2.1 practicum task** (compare two texts) produces a comparison. Use it to open Topic 2.2: ask trainees which reading strategies would work best for each text.
- **Topic 2.2 practicum task** (observe a reading lesson) produces an observation. Use it to make the point that many pupils are never taught reading strategies explicitly.
- **Topic 2.3 practicum task** (analyse a textbook passage) produces a full analysis. Use it to make the point that the skills from Topics 2.1 and 2.2 combine in practice.

A note on the figures

The unit carries six figures: two concept-map figures (fig-U2-1, fig-U2-6), two flowchart figures (fig-U2-2, fig-U2-3), and two table figures (fig-U2-4, fig-U2-5). The tables are the ones trainees most often try to read as prose. Before you project any of them, ask trainees to read the column headers first and say what the table is comparing.

Assessment note

The 10/10/5 bank is designed to be used in two passes: the MCQs and RRQs as formative checks at the end of Topics 2.2 and 2.3, and the ERQs as a summative task at the end of the unit. ERQ 5 (the integrative item) is the one that most reliably separates trainees who have understood the unit from those who have memorised its definitions. If you use only one ERQ, use that one.

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

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